



PRAISE THE FROST

*The Blizzard of Heartbreak is always on the horizon.
Bring a coat. Bring your ex's crown.
Leave the glitter — it'll follow you anyway.*

*The High Winter Elves of Girlville is an unofficial fan adaptation.
The original game is described in The Onion's reporting;
this Cortex Prime conversion is a work of parody and affection.
Not affiliated with Olivia Rodrigo, The Onion, or Fandom Tabletop.*



A CORTEX PRIME GAME

The High Winter Elves of Girlville

*Reclaim the Frost Kingdom. The princes were once your lovers.
The glitter is both a currency and a character affliction.*



An unofficial Primed-by-Cortex adaptation of the high-fantasy tabletop game described in *The Onion's* reporting, the lore-dense, user-centered gameplay experience about the enchanted Frost Kingdom of Girlville and the feminine race of winter elves trying to reclaim it from the grasp of a dozen princes who were once their lovers. Playable in a one-shot or a months-long campaign.

Requires the Cortex Prime Game Handbook · 3-5 players · Print duplex, flip on long edge



◆ Genre, Theme & Mood

"There are real stakes here: You might be in the middle of a raid at the Mines of Glimmör and suddenly a bad roll makes your closest party member reveal she's been sleeping with your dwarven ex."

— from the original game's press tour

Genre. Romantic dark fantasy run through high-school melodrama, with a vein of pop-cosmic horror underneath. On the handbook's buffet this is **High Fantasy + Romance + High School** — snow fortresses, frost dungeons, and dance clubs; bosses who are your exes; a prom that matters as much as any battlefield. It sits far on the *fantastic* end of the axis: Cryomancy is real, the Blizzard of Heartbreak is weather *and* a feeling, and goblins and wizards go to prom together.

Theme. Reclamation — of a kingdom, of a self, of a story that someone else got to tell about you. Every mechanic in this game asks the same question the source material asks: *what does it cost to take back what was yours, and who do you become while you're taking it?* Obsession, emotional turbulence, and jealousy aren't flaws to sand off your character; they're fuel, and like all fuel, they burn.

Mood. Everything sparkles and everything can cut you. Play it glitter-bright on the surface — entrances, dance floors, coronets — and let the cold underneath do the real work. The game is at its best when a triumph feels like a music video and a failure feels like reading old texts at 2 a.m.

What you need to play

The Cortex Prime Game Handbook, a set of polyhedral dice per player, glitter tokens (actual glitter, if you dare), and 3–5 players. One player is the **GM**, who runs the Twelve Princes, the factions, and the Blizzard of Heartbreak itself. Everyone else plays a winter elf of Girlville — or a fester witch, a sewer orc, or a goblin, because prom is for everybody.

A note on the adaptation

The original box set's famous "eureka moment" was a switch to percentile dice. This adaptation translates the game to Cortex Prime pools instead — rolled and kept, never added — because heartbreak, like dice, is about which two moments you keep and what you do with the rest. All mechanics below are expressed in actual Cortex Prime terms: opposition is always a Doom Pool, a Crisis Pool, or a named GMC — never a contest against a faction.

◆ Trait Sets & Distinctions

Every PC is built from three prime sets — **Values**, **Relationships**, and **Roles** — plus **Distinctions** and the setting's signature extras: **Cryomancy** abilities, **Perks**, and a pool of **Glitter**. Only one trait from a given set enters a pool for free; a second costs a glitter die.

- **Growing characters:** Milestones & XP (one personal — about your ex; one group — reclaim Girlville; 1/3/10 XP tiers; standard unlockables).
- **Conflicts:** Tests; Contests (vs. named GMCs only); Crisis Pools; Doom Pool (The Blizzard of Heartbreak, replaces difficulty dice); Ganging Up; Timed Tests.
- **Turn order:** Dramatic Order (default); Action Order (raids).
- **Dice & rolling:** Hero Dice; Static Difficulty (optional, for fast convention slots).
- **Complications:** Complications as harm (includes Glitter-touched variants: Ice, Rot, Charm); Double Jeopardy.
- **Glitter:** the currency — no plot points; Bank + Pile; spend or roll; custom spends: Déjà Vu reroll, Feed (Vampirism), staying in a scene via Road-Crew Tough; Ice/Rot/Charm descriptor tags.
- **GMCs:** Major GMCs (the Twelve Princes, Valford the Girly Mage); Minor GMCs; Extras; Mobs; Location GMCs (the Grand Frost Ballroom, the Mines of Glimmör).

Growth: Milestones

Each PC carries **two milestones**: one personal (about your ex — *"Get my coronet back from Cassian,"* 1 XP when his name costs you, 3 XP when you confront him in a scene, 10 XP when it's resolved, closing the milestone) and one group (*"Reclaim the Frost Kingdom of Girlville,"* shared 1/3/10 XP triggers). Banked XP buys **unlockables**: 5 XP for a new perk, an SFX unlock, or a ▼ signature asset; 10 XP to step a trait to 10 or learn a new Cryomancy branch (with its glyph); 15 XP for 12 steps; 20 XP for the top tier. When an unlock would step up a Cryomancy branch or witch ability, you may instead add a new tag (Ice, Rot, or Charm) to it — a new way to use the ability, per the Codex. Months-long campaigns should also let challenged Value statements rewrite the character — that's the real advancement here.

For the original box set owners

If you own the \$79.99 deluxe box: the Olivia Rodrigo-branded dice bag is a perfectly good glitter purse, and the Valford the Girly Mage miniature makes an excellent session-long ♦ asset — once per session, place Valford on the table to declare that the Girly Mage *personally* vouches for you. The percentile dice are lovely. Keep them for the slow dances.

Reveals

- **For the Scorned:** Cassian isn't wearing your coronet tonight. He *gave it away* — to someone at this prom. She's wearing it *wrong*.
- **For the Witch:** the coven's Rot Glitter charge isn't just a bomb. It's *bait* — for whatever has been whispering in the Glitter since before Girlville had a name.
- **For the Mage:** the Seventh Glyph around Anselm's neck is warm to Snowblind sight. Glyphs are never warm. Something is *growing* in it.
- **For the Prom Queen:** Jaspas's mercenaries aren't here as guests. They're here as *security* — and their contract says the prom ends when *he* says so.
- **For the ballroom:** the gelatinous beast got loose in the Mines of Glimmör an hour ago, and the service tunnels run *directly under the dance floor*. The bass is keeping it calm. If the music stops —
- **For the princes:** the Twelve didn't come to celebrate. They came because the Blizzard told them to. Corvin has been married to it for a year, and it is *jealous*.

Opening scenes (pick one, or let the prom pick for you)

1. **Red-carpet arrivals.** Dramatic order. Each PC makes an entrance — Socialite or Glamour against the Doom Pool — and then their ex arrives with someone new. The GM inflicts each prince's *Wound He Left* on introduction. No one has danced yet and two people are already crying. This is correct.
2. **The Mines alarm.** Action order. A runner bursts in mid-first dance: the beast is loose, the tunnels are humming, and the bass cannot hold forever. Raid the Mines of Glimmör *in formal wear*, whittle down the **Gelatinous Beast** crisis pool, and be back before the slow dance — where, the GM notes with a straight face, a bad roll may reveal your closest party member has been sleeping with your dwarven ex.
3. **The slow dance.** Dramatic order, one contest. Anselm crosses the floor and asks the Mage — or whoever holds the highest ex-Relationship die — to dance. It's a contest, and the prize is the Seventh Glyph. The Blizzard of Heartbreak grows a die every exchange nobody gives in. The whole ballroom is watching. Give them something to watch.

GM advice: run the feeling, not the map

Girlville is a game about people who used to love each other holding a kingdom hostage. Frame scenes around *wants stated out loud* — dramatic order does the rest. Let hitches become complications, not just failures; let the Doom Pool spend itself on entrances, interruptions, and exes arriving at the worst moment. When in doubt, ask the table: *"What does your character want right now, and who here knows it?"* Then let the dice be honest about the answer.

♦ Mod Loadout — The Prix Fixe

Every mod in play, grouped by the handbook's categories:

- **Trait & trait mods:** Distinctions (always, with Hinder); Values (with challengeable Trait Statements); Relationships (plus Reputations variant for factions); Roles; Abilities as Cryomancy branches (six-branch Ability List); Signature Assets; Talents (peoples & perks); SFX (standard six, plus Déjà Vu and Vampirism); Limits (Conscious Activation, Growing Dread on Thaw).
- **Character creation:** Archetypes (default, ten-minute); Scratch-Built; Pathways (optional, for the who-dated-whom campaign).

Values

How intensely your elf is invested in an idea — a high rating is intensity, not virtue. Assign 10, 8, 6, 4, 2, 1, one per value. Each Value carries a **statement** you write for your character; a statement can be **challenged** — act directly against it to triple the die for one roll, then step the Value down afterward.

Value	What it measures	Example statement
Heartbreak	How much of you is still back there	"I never cry at the ballroom anymore."
Obsession	How tightly you hold a thought	"I have memorized every lie he told."
Devotion	What you would burn for	"Girlville comes before my pride."
Glamour	How the room sees you	"I arrive like weather."
Jealousy	What you can't stand to lose	"No one outshines me twice."
Spite	What keeps you warm	"I hope his crown itches."

Relationships

Intensity of a bond to another character or group, 12 ("barely registers") to 1 ("nobody matters more"), each with a short statement. Every PC names at least **three** Relationships — and **at least one must be an ex**: a former lover, ideally one of the Twelve Princes, who still has a die with your name on it. Ex Relationships start one step higher than you assign (to a max of 12); the past is load-bearing here.

Reputations variant: one Relationship slot may instead be a standing with a faction — the **Guild of Lacy Shadows** or the **Mercenaries at Makeout Forge** — rated the same way. Factions are employers and informants, never opposition pools.

Roles

Broad career competence rather than individual skills. Assign 10, 8, 6, 4, 2, 1, one per role:

- **Raider** — infiltration, theft, dungeon-crawling; the Mines of Glimmör are your second home.
- **Cryomancer** — frost magic. You must know at least one Cryomancy branch to roll this Role above 4.
- **Socialite** — dance clubs, courts, proms, reading a room in one glance.
- **Witch** — putrescence, curses, dark energy. Fester witches begin with this at 8 or better.
- **Blade** — duels, bodyguarding, entrances that end conversations.

Distinctions

Three per PC at 8, each with the free **Hinder** SFX (*gain a glitter die (your choice of kind) when you swap this 8 for a 4*). Examples:

- *Frostgate Princess in Exile* — highlight: Socialite, Glamour
- *Gen Con Playtest Survivor* — highlight: Raider, Witch
- *Crystal Ballroom Regular* — highlight: Socialite, Blade
- *Road-Crew Bodyguard Trained* — highlight: Blade, Raider
- *Dethroned Prom Royalty* — highlight: Glamour, Spite

• *Writes in the Seven Sacred Glyphs* — highlight: Cryomancer, Witch



◆ The Peoples of Glamwendia

The Ancient Realm of Glamwendia holds snow fortresses, frost dungeons, and dance clubs — and all of them are open to every people. Choose one at creation; each grants a **Talent** (a described capability with its own SFX and no die rating, tied to a related Role).

High Winter Elf

The feminine race of the Frost Kingdom of Girlville, born of the long night and the long memory. Elves feel everything at full volume and remember all of it.

Talent: *Winter's Memory*

Activation: when someone lies to you about the past. **Effect:** spend a glitter die to declare one true thing about what really happened — the fiction bends, not the dice. (Elves do not misremember. It is their blessing and their entire problem.)

Fester Witch

A cavern-dwelling feminine race that turns putrescence into dark energy. What rots, they rule. Other peoples find them unsettling at galas; the witches find other peoples unsettling everywhere else. Fester witch abilities carry the **Rot** tag by nature.

Talent: *Rot to Power*

Activation: once per session, when you take a complication. **Effect:** instead of recording it, convert it into an asset of the same size — the rot becomes the fuel. Describe what festers and what it powers.

Sewer Orc

Tunnel-born, thick-skinned, fluent in the languages of damp stone and bad decisions. Sewer orcs ended up in the Frost Kingdom the way everyone interesting ends up anywhere: following someone they shouldn't have.

Talent: *Down There With You*

Activation: when an ally takes a complication in a frost dungeon, sewer, or similarly miserable hole. **Effect:** take a 6 version of that complication onto yourself and step their complication down one — orcs know exactly how bad it is down there, and they go anyway.

Goblin

Quick, glitter-mad, and socially frictionless in the way only someone with nothing to lose can be. Goblins run half the dance clubs in Glamwendia and all of the afterparties.

The Girly Mage

PEOPLE — High winter elf · **SIGN** — The Snowflake

DISTINCTIONS — 8 *Valford's Star Apprentice*; 8 *Writes in the Seven Sacred Glyphs*; 8 *Arrives Like Weather*

VALUES — Glamour 10, Obsession 8, Devotion 8, Heartbreak 6, Jealousy 6, Spite 4

ROLES — Cryomancer 10, Socialite 8, Witch 8, Raider 6, Blade 4

RELATIONSHIPS — Prince Anselm (ex) 10; Valford the Girly Mage 8; The glyph-archive 6

CRYOMANCY — Glint 8, Snowblind 6 · **PERKS** — Feminine Intuition, Dance-Floor Diplomacy

ASSET — *Olivia Rodrigo-branded dice bag* 6 · **GLITTER** — 6×3 (Charm)

WANT — the seventh glyph, and for Anselm to give it back himself

The Dethroned Prom Queen

PEOPLE — Goblin · **SIGN** — The Prom Queen · **TALENT** — *Plus-One*

DISTINCTIONS — 8 *Dethroned Prom Royalty*; 8 *Runs the Afterparty*; 8 *Knows the Bouncer*

VALUES — Jealousy 10, Glamour 8, Heartbreak 8, Spite 6, Devotion 6, Obsession 4

ROLES — Socialite 10, Raider 8, Blade 8, Witch 6, Cryomancer 4

RELATIONSHIPS — Prince Jaspar Makeout (ex) 10; The Crystal Ballroom staff 8; Her wizard plus-one 6

PERKS — Dance-Floor Diplomacy, Promposal · **ASSET** — *A sash that says almost everything* 6

GLITTER — 6×3 (Charm) · **WANT** — the crown back, the club back, the last word



◆ Session One: The Winter Prom

The situation

Tonight is the **Winter Prom** at the Grand Frost Ballroom — the biggest dance-club night in the Ancient Realm of Glamwendia, and the first prom since the princes took the Frost Kingdom. Every prince will be there, wearing something that used to be yours. Prince Anselm arrives flaunting the **Seventh Glyph** around his neck — the one the scholars say was never written. The Fester Witches have offered the PCs a **Rot Glitter charge** big enough to crack the ballroom's frost-dome. And the Blizzard of Heartbreak is one bad slow-dance away from descending on all of it.

This is a situation, not a plot. The PCs want the kingdom, the glyph, their dignity, or just a good night — the prom will give them chances at all four and punish them for reaching.

◆ Sample Characters

Four archetypes, ready for the ten-minute method. Each lists Distinctions, Values, Roles, Relationships, Cryomancy, perks, Glitter, and a signature asset — fill in statements at the table, in your character's voice.

The Scorned Raider

PEOPLE — High winter elf · **SIGN** — The Dagger
DISTINCTIONS — ◆ *Frostgate Princess in Exile*; ◆ *Mines of Glimmör Veteran*; ◆ *Reads Old Texts at 2 A.M.*
VALUES — Spite 10, Heartbreak ◆, Devotion ◆, Obsession 6, Jealousy 6, Glamour 4
ROLES — Raider 10, Blade ◆, Witch ◆, Socialite 6, Cryomancer 4
RELATIONSHIPS — Prince Cassian (ex) 10; The crew from the Mines ◆; Valford the Girly Mage 6
PERKS — Cold Read, Road-Crew Tough · **ASSET** — *Glyph-inscribed lockpicks* 6
GLITTER — 6 × 3 (Rot) · **WANT** — her coronet back, and for him to watch her take it

The Fester Witch

PEOPLE — Fester witch · **SIGN** — The Wolf · **TALENT** — *Rot to Power*
DISTINCTIONS — ◆ *Cavern-Born and Proud of It*; ◆ *Turns Putrescence Into Dark Energy*; ◆ *Unsettling at Galas*
VALUES — Devotion 10, Obsession ◆, Spite ◆, Jealousy 6, Heartbreak 6, Glamour 4
ROLES — Witch 10, Raider ◆, Cryomancer ◆, Blade 6, Socialite 4
RELATIONSHIPS — Prince Sable Mor (ex) 10; The coven below the frost ◆; Her first rot-garden 6
PERKS — Glitter Sense, Promposal · **ASSET** — *A jar of prime putrescence* 6
GLITTER — 6 × 3 (Rot) · **WANT** — to prove rot is just love with the shine off

Talent: *Plus-One*

Activation: at the start of any social scene. **Effect:** you are on the list, you know the bouncer, and you brought a friend — introduce one Extra ally for the scene, no questions asked. (Wizards are always goblins' plus-ones. It is tradition.)

Star Signs

During character creation every PC chooses an **astrological sign** — the constellation under which their heart first broke. Your sign unlocks one SFX for free at creation, usable with the trait named:

Sign	Unlocked SFX (with...)
The Snowflake	The Edit with Cryomancer — declare one true thing about the ice
The Gelatinous Beast	The Folly with Blade — earn a glitter die (your choice of kind) charging something huge
The Dagger	The Swap with Raider — use Raider where Blade would fit
The Crown	The Exchange with Glamour — step up Glamour, step down Spite this scene
The Mirror	The Edit with Socialite — declare what someone <i>really</i> feels
The Wolf	The Price with Witch — step up Witch, take a ◆
The Star	The Shutdown with Spite — earn a glitter die (your choice of kind), Spite unusable this scene
The Prom Queen	The Swap with Socialite — use Socialite where Cryomancer would fit
The Dungeon	The Folly with Raider — earn a glitter die (your choice of kind) splitting the party
The Prince	The Price with an ex-Relationship — step it up, take a ◆
The Witch	The Exchange with Heartbreak — step up Heartbreak, step down Obsession this scene
The Glitter	The Edit with Glitter dice — declare where glitter can be found

◆ Perks

Choose **two perks** at creation. Perks are Talents — no die rating, each with its own activation and effect — representing the small unfair advantages that get you through character creation and, honestly, life:

- **Feminine Intuition** — *Activation:* spend a glitter die when someone is hiding a feeling. *Effect:* the GM answers one question about what they feel, truthfully.

- **Dance-Floor Diplomacy** — *Activation*: at the start of a social contest. *Effect*: your first roll treats your Socialite die as stepped up once; if you lead with dancing, step it up twice.
- **Cold Read** — *Activation*: when meeting a prince for the first time. *Effect*: learn his *Wound He Left* (see p. 11) before he can use it.
- **Glitter Sense** — *Activation*: when entering a new location. *Effect*: the GM tells you where the nearest unclaimed Glitter is, what kind, and which tags hang thickest on the location.
- **Promposal** — *Activation*: once per session. *Effect*: declare that someone present owes you a dance, a favor, or an explanation. They do.
- **Road-Crew Tough** — *Activation*: when a complication would take you out of a scene. *Effect*: spend a glitter die to stay, with the complication stepped up one instead.



✦ Cryomancy

The frost-based magic of Girlville, crafted to mimic the **six branches of a snowflake**. Cryomancy uses the **Ability List**: each branch is a single rated trait bundling its descriptor, limit, and SFX, with one effect tag and one descriptor tag — Ice, Rot, or Charm (see Tags, p. 8). A PC with the Cryomancer Role knows **two branches** at creation — one at **◆**, one at **■**. Others may learn a branch later by inscribing its glyph (see p. 8) and spending a Milestone unlock. Each branch carries the limit **Conscious Activation** — it shuts down while you are taken out — plus its own limit below.

The Six Branches

* **Heartfrost** — Attack, Control **(ICE)**

Weaponize emotional cold; freeze what you cannot forgive. *Limit*: cannot harm someone you hold no grudge against — the ice needs a reason. *SFX*: **Shatter** — spend a glitter die to step up your effect die against a target suffering a Heartbreak complication.

* **Glassveil** — Defense **(CHARM)**

Armor of mirror-ice; deflects blades and scrutiny alike. *Limit*: while active, your Glamour complications step up — everyone can see themselves in you, and some of them don't like it. *SFX*: **Reflect** — spend a glitter die to turn an attacker's effect die into a complication on them instead of you.

* **Snowblind** — Sensory **(ICE)**

Read the storm; every flake remembers where it has been. *Limit*: visions arrive as weather, never words — the GM describes, you interpret. *SFX*: **Whiteout Memory** — spend a glitter die to ask the storm one question about the past of your current location.

* **Deeppdrift** — Movement **(ICE)**

Travel the snow between places; vanish into a whiteout and step out somewhere colder. *Limit*: you cannot arrive anywhere warm — the drift only goes downhill in temperature. *SFX*: **Cut Across** — spend a glitter die to arrive mid-scene somewhere you were not, with a **◆ Out of Nowhere** asset.

included in tests or contests against him at all. *Spent* glitter is never "included," so immunity blocks only *rolled* dice — Charm glitter is still spendable against a Charm-immune prince, just not rollable.

Prince Cassian the Coronet-Thief. Wears your crown and your patience is gone. *Wound*: *He's Wearing It* **◆**. **Undone by**: Rot · **Immune to**: Charm

Prince Anselm of the Seventh Glyph. Stole a sacred glyph for a necklace. *Wound*: *Sacrilege, But Make It Fashion* **◆**. **Undone by**: Ice · **Immune to**: Charm

Prince Milo Ravensent. Ended it by raven, in winter, during a siege. *Wound*: *Read at Midnight* **◆**. **Undone by**: Charm · **Immune to**: Ice

Prince Dorian Glimmör. Sold the Mines to fund his glow-up. *Wound*: *Everything Has a Price, Apparently You* **◆**. **Undone by**: Rot · **Immune to**: Charm

Prince Fenwick Underthrone. Rules the sewers now; sends up notes. *Wound*: *A Letter, Damp* **■**. **Undone by**: Ice · **Immune to**: Rot

Prince Halloran Frostbane. Claims he "doesn't remember it that way." *Wound*: *Winter's Memory Says Otherwise* **◆**. **Undone by**: Ice · **Immune to**: Charm

Prince Ivo Lacehand. Runs the Guild of Lacy Shadows like a spurned fan club. *Wound*: *He Knows About the Texts* **◆**. **Undone by**: Charm · **Immune to**: Rot

Prince Jaspar Makeout. Founded the Mercenaries at Makeout Forge; all contracts paid in kisses and regret. *Wound*: *Still Owes You a Dance* **■**. **Undone by**: Ice · **Immune to**: Charm

Prince Corvin Snowmere. Married the Blizzard. It seems happy. *Wound*: *Replaced by Weather* **◆**. **Undone by**: Rot · **Immune to**: Ice

Prince Larkspur Vell. A wizard, technically; a disappointment, specifically. *Wound*: *He Tried His Best (He Didn't)* **■**. **Undone by**: Charm · **Immune to**: Rot

Prince Sable Mor. Fester-witch adjacent; collects apologies he never gives. *Wound*: *An Apology Shaped Hole* **◆**. **Undone by**: Ice · **Immune to**: Rot

Prince Wren of Nowhere. Nobody's ex. Shows up anyway. Knows things. *Wound*: *Why Is He Here* **◆**. **Undone by**: Rot · **Immune to**: Charm

Valford the Girly Mage

Major GMC and the closest thing Girlville has to a mentor. Valford designed half the glyph-inscriptions in the kingdom and all of the best entrances. He gives quests, lends his miniature (a **◆** signature asset, *Valford Himself, In Miniature*, to one PC per session), and absolutely will take your side against a prince — for a price in Glitter and gossip.

Factions

The Guild of Lacy Shadows — spies, gossips, and ex-lovers' ex-assistants; they know everything and sell most of it. **The Mercenaries at Makeout Forge** — blades for hire, paid in coin, kisses, or closure. Both are available as Reputation Relationships, employers, and informants. Per the standing rule of this adaptation: never run a contest *against* a faction — run it against the named cutout they send, in the room, right now.

The Doom Pool: The Blizzard of Heartbreak

The setting's looming threat is weather, heartbreak, and weather-as-heartbreak. The Doom Pool **replaces difficulty dice for every test** and is the GM's glitter-purse. It opens each session at **2**  (colder for higher-stakes campaigns).

- **It grows** whenever the GM activates a player's hitch — add a die sized to the hitch, or step one up, *instead of* granting a complication. Heartbreak feeds the storm.
- **It spends** to set difficulty (pick dice, roll, keep best two — those dice leave the pool), to push a die into a prince's pool mid-contest, or for scene-level effects: create a complication or asset, interrupt action order, introduce an ex mid-scene, split the party at prom, or **end the scene on a freeze-frame**.

When the Doom Pool holds more than twice as many dice as there are players, the Blizzard **descends**: the next scene opens in whiteout conditions, all recovery tests step up once, and every ex-Relationship in play may be activated by the GM for free. The storm always knows.

Crisis Pools

Localized, whittle-down-able problems — a smaller doom-pool variant for when the antagonist is the situation. PCs test directly against the crisis to shrink it; at zero dice, it's resolved.

- **The Gelatinous Beast** (Mines of Glimmör) — a quivering , ,  crisis. It does not hate you. It is simply *there*, and it is *huge*.
- **The Collapsing Frostgate** — , , ; timed tests, 3 beats, or the east wing of Girlville becomes a very pretty ruin.
- **The Slow Dance** — , ; a social crisis. Someone has to say what everyone's thinking before the song ends.

Glitter, briefly

Start with  ×3 (your choice of kinds); gain one more each session; unspent glitter carries over. **Earn** by accepting hitch complications, giving in during contests, challenging a Value, Hinder, strong roleplay, or rolling a -rated trait. **Spend** dice 1-for-1 on fiction, SFX, déjà vu, extra dice, assets, interference, or staying in the scene — or **roll** them as Resources and risk the affliction. Every glitter die carries its kind's tag: Ice, Rot, or Charm. The GM keeps a **Bank** (one die per player, for keeping princes in the fight) and an unlimited **Pile**.

♦ The Opposition

The Frost Kingdom of Girlville is held by **a dozen princes who were once the elves' lovers**. They are Major GMCs — named, statted, and contestable. Each carries a **Wound He Left**: a complication the GM may inflict on introduction (no roll, once per prince per campaign — he only gets to make a first impression once). Each prince is **undone by** one tag and **immune to** another. **Undone by**: when your pool includes a die carrying that tag in a contest against him, step up your effect die one — you found the crack. **Immune to**: dice carrying that tag cannot be

* Glint — Enhancement

Sharpen allies like starlight on ice; lend your shine to someone else's edge. *Limit*: the target's next failure is *yours* socially — Glint marks the giver. *SFX*: **Starlight Loan** — step down your Glint die for the scene to step up an ally's Glamour or Blade die.

* Thaw — Control

The forbidden warm branch: it melts, it mends, it ends. Thaw can heal complications and end enchantments — including the ones you like. *Limit*: **Growing Dread** — 1s and 2s hitch when rolling Thaw; the warmth remembers what the cold was protecting you from. *SFX*: **Spring's Price** — spend a glitter die to step down any complication by two steps instead of one on a recovery test.



♦ The Glitter

The Glitter is **both a currency and a character affliction** — the economy and the cosmic horror are the same substance. It comes in three kinds: **Ice**, **Rot**, and **Charm**. There is a little bit of cosmic horror tied into all of it. The Glitter is older than Girlville, and on quiet nights it whispers in a voice like a music box playing one note wrong.

There are no plot points in Girlville. There is only glitter. Each PC tracks **Glitter** as a pool of  dice, starting with **3** — your choice of kinds. At the start of each session, gain one more glitter die (your choice of kind); unspent glitter carries over.

Earning glitter

Earn a glitter die — your choice of kind — the way heroines always have: accept a hitch complication, give in during a contest, challenge a Value, Hinder a Distinction, unforgettable roleplay, or roll a -rated trait. Glitter can also be **mined** in the Mines of Glimmör — the vein's kind is the GM's call (mostly Ice; Rot seams in the deep dark; Charm near the old ballroom).

Spending glitter

Spend a glitter die 1-for-1 on anything the fiction allows — club entry, bribes, spell components, a prince's attention, a faster sledge — or on any classic gambit: activate an SFX, add a die, create an asset, keep an extra die, interfere in a contest, trigger **déjà vu**, or stay standing by taking the complication instead of being taken out. Spent dice are gone — no roll, no risk. The Blizzard keeps them.

Rolling glitter

Roll unspent glitter dice as **Resources**: add any number to a pool, but rolled dice are spent and only the highest counts toward your total. This is the dangerous half. Whenever a glitter die you *roll* comes up a **hitch**, the Glitter takes hold: gain a **Glitter-touched** complication (, or stepped up if you already carry one), named for the kind that claimed you — and the complication **carries that kind's tag**. Each kind afflicts differently:

- **Ice — Numb**. The cold gets in and stays. Ice complications can only be recovered in genuine warmth — a recovery test requires another PC present and willing, or it automatically fails.
- **Rot — Festering**. Doubt rots you from the inside. At the start of any scene you enter alone, the GM steps your Rot complication up one. Company is the only preservative.

- **Charm — Beglamoured.** You cannot stop looking at how it sparkles. Once per scene the GM may activate your Charm complication against you for free.

If every die in a pool hitches and glitter was in the pool — a glitter **botch** — the GM may add a die to the Doom Pool *instead of* handing you a complication. The Glitter does not punish you. It *notices* you.

Tags: Ice, Rot, Charm

Ice, Rot, and Charm are **descriptor tags** — in the Cortex Codex sense, they say *how* a thing works. Everything glitter-related already carries its kind's tag: glitter dice, mined veins, Glitter-touched complications. Cryomancy branches carry one tag each (p. 7); fester witch abilities are Rot-tagged by nature. Tags unlock SFX, feed prince vulnerabilities (p. 11), and can be added to a branch or witch ability through growth *instead of* stepping up its die — your Glassveil learns Rot, and now your beautiful illusions fester.

Déjà vu & Vampirism

Déjà vu — spend a glitter die after seeing your total to reroll your entire pool and take the new result. *"This has happened before."* Once per test; you cannot déjà vu a déjà vu.

Vampirism — an optional SFX any PC may take at creation: *Feed*.

Activation: a willing or helpless character with glitter dice or a Glitter-touched complication. **Effect:** drain them — step down your Glitter-touched complication one (or take glitter dice from their pool into yours) and step *their* complication up one. The fiction should feel exactly as bad as it sounds.

The Seven Sacred Glyphs of Girlville

The elven script of the Frost Kingdom — six glyphs name the six branches of Cryomancy, and each branch is learned by inscribing its glyph in ice that never melts. The **seventh glyph** is missing from every text. Scholars say it was never written; witches say it was unwritten; the princes say it doesn't exist, a little too quickly. Learning a new Cryomancy branch in play requires finding a glyph-inscription and spending a Milestone unlock — finding the *seventh* is a campaign.

♦ Character Creation

The original game was built to satisfy in one-shot sessions *and* months-long campaigns. This adaptation defaults to **Archetypes** — pick a pre-built partial character and be playing in ten minutes — with full **scratch-built** rules underneath for groups that want total ownership.

Archetype method (ten minutes)

1. **Choose a people:** high winter elf, fester witch, sewer orc, or goblin. Take its Talent.
2. **Choose an archetype** (pp. 12–13) or build freely: assign Values (10, 8, 8, 6, 6, 4), Roles (10, 8, 8, 6, 4), and three Relationships (at least one an ex).
3. **Choose three Distinctions** at 8 (Hinder free). Note two highlight traits per Distinction.

4. **Choose a star sign;** unlock its SFX.
5. **Choose two perks.**
6. **Cryomancy (optional):** if you took the Cryomancer Role, choose two branches — one at 8, one at 6.
7. **Take 6 × 3 Glitter** (your choice of kinds) and one signature asset at 6 (a coronet, a glyph-inscribed blade, an Olivia Rodrigo-branded dice bag — the fiction is yours).
8. **Write Value statements** — one line each, in your character's voice. Then name your prince.

Scratch-built method (a session)

Follow the steps above, but choose everything freely: write your own three Distinctions and unlock two SFX beyond Hinder; instead of fixed Role/Value arrays, distribute per the standard rules (Values trade up and down in pairs; Roles baseline 10/8/4 with two floating steps); spend **five points** on specialties and signature assets. Groups that want the drama to emerge from shared history should instead run **Pathways**, mapping who-dated-whom across the Twelve Princes' courts — the relationship map this setting deserves.

Naming your prince

One of your Relationships must be an ex. The Twelve Princes (p. 11) are shared fiction — pick one, or invent your own and tell the GM which throne he stole. Write the statement as the wound, not the person: *"Cassian wears my coronet and my patience is gone"* (10). He will show up. That is the entire point of the game.

♦ Conflict & Harm

Harm: Complications

This game uses **Complications** as its harm mod — flexible enough to cover a sword wound, a ruined reputation, and a broken heart in the same scene, because in Girlville those are frequently the same scene. Setbacks land as named complications (*Slashed Bodice* 8, *Humiliated at the Ball* 10); recover with a recovery test against 8 + 8 plus the complication's own die. A complication stepped past 12 takes you out of the scene — dramatically, on a freeze-frame, ideally mid-dance.

Turn order

Dramatic order by default — whoever states a want becomes the dramatic lead; play flows contest to contest. Suits a game that is mostly interpersonal warfare. Switch to **action order** for raids (the Mines of Glimmör, a frost-dungeon breach, prom night when it all kicks off): the GM picks an action lead, everyone takes one act around the table, last actor picks next round's lead.

Contests

Run contests **only against named GMCs** — the Twelve Princes, Valford, a Fester Witch matriarch, a named rival. Everything else is a test. In a high-stakes scene, compare **effect dice** (not totals) for taken-out vs. complicated: bigger effect die than the loser's means taken out; the loser may spend a glitter die to take the complication instead.